The Waterfront Brief

Weekly sustainment intelligence for naval shipyard leadership · Naval shipbuilding, ship repair, and fleet sustainment

Vol. 1, No. 15, Week 43 **October 23, 2026**

Truman arrived at Newport News for its refueling overhaul on September 30. Stennis, in the same yard since May 2021, is now scheduled to leave in April 2028, so two carrier overhauls are planned to share the yard until then. All eight large Korean yard jobs on Navy supply ships the desk found since 2024 ran past their contract dates and grew 27 to 401 percent in value; the newest contract carries line items for growth work. Fitting a hypersonic missile into Zumwalt added 230,000 hours of unplanned work, including more cabling than the design planned and the first restart of the class's key systems, GAO reported. And a $60 million expansion of the private propeller foundry at Pascagoula, $22 million of the Navy's share from Australia, adds machining capacity that in-service and new-construction submarines will share, from early 2028 by the company's date.

How to read this: where a sentence names where something came from, those words are a link to the source itself, and the sentence says what that source says. A sentence with no link is this desk's analysis, built only on the linked facts above it. Two warnings are still written out in the text: Speculation, and Unverified for a claim nobody here could check against a primary source, with the reason it could not be checked.

WATERFRONT OPS & PRODUCTION

Two carrier overhauls are scheduled to overlap at Newport News until April 2028

Truman left Norfolk for Newport News on September 30 for its refueling overhaul, and Stennis, in the same yard since May 2021, is now scheduled to leave in April 2028. That is five months later than the Navy's June 2025 budget said, and the fourth delivery date on the record.

The first two dates come from the 2025 budget. USNI News reported in June 2024 that the Navy's fiscal 2025 budget documents pushed Stennis's finish from August 2025 to October 2026. It said the program executive for carriers put the delays down to shortfalls that had stretched George Washington's overhaul.

That earlier overlap ran from 2021 to 2023. HII said on May 25, 2023 that it had redelivered George Washington from its overhaul at Newport News and that work continued there on Stennis.

The next book moved Stennis again. The Navy's fiscal 2026 shipbuilding budget book, dated June 2025 put delivery at November 2027 and asked for about $480 million "due to an additional 13 month delivery delay."

The latest book gives a cause. The fiscal 2027 book, dated April 2026 lists Stennis's start in May 2021 and says delivery "has been extended to April 2028 due to the current pace of work and testing in support of Steam Plant Testing."

Truman's award moved and its start did not. The June 2025 book's schedule table planned Truman's contract for June 2026, its start for September 2026 and delivery for January 2031. The April 2026 book kept the start and moved the award to September 2026 for "a late proposal delivery from the shipbuilder."

The end date moved for the work itself. The fiscal 2027 book moved Truman's redelivery to November 2031 for "the assessed 62-month schedule," which it ties to "the ship's overall condition, including the largest-ever tank package," plus four main engines not previously planned.

Contract and ship came the same week. The Navy announced on September 29 a $5.1 billion contract to Newport News Shipbuilding for the overhaul, and the Navy said on October 1 that Truman "departed Naval Station Norfolk Sept. 30."

So Truman headed in while Stennis was scheduled to stay about 19 more months.

A third hull is already scheduled behind Truman. The fiscal 2027 book's schedule table puts the next overhaul, hull CVN 76, at the same builder from October 2030 to February 2035, which overlaps Truman's planned finish by about 13 months.

One carrier left as Truman's contract came. USNI News reported on September 29 that Kennedy left Newport News that day under preliminary acceptance, quoting the Navy's release that the shipbuilder was still completing "testing of the remaining four Advanced Weapons Elevators."

Stennis's April 2028 date was set while the steam plant testing that drove it was still under way. Expect next spring's budget book to move Stennis again for that testing pace, and Truman's date to hold until its condition-driven work is opened up.

WHY IT MATTERS

Bottom line: When an overhaul's finish has moved several times and always later, plan whatever follows it (the next hull, the trades rolling off, the staged material) with margin behind the latest date. Slips caused by end-of-overhaul testing and by condition found after opening have kept moving.

Sources: Department of the Navy, FY2026 Shipbuilding and Conversion budget justification, June 2025; Department of the Navy, FY2027 Shipbuilding and Conversion budget justification, April 2026; U.S. Navy, Sep 29, 2026; U.S. Navy, Oct 1, 2026; USNI News, Jun 18, 2024; USNI News, Sep 29, 2026; HII, May 25, 2023

OPERATIONS MAINTENANCE & READINESS

All eight big Korean jobs on Navy supply ships ran past their contract dates

Since 2024 the Navy has sent Military Sealift Command ships to Korean yards for eight large availabilities that the desk could find, and all eight ran past the completion date set at award. The growth was priced and approved by modification after award.

The search covered federal award records for ship repair in Korea since mid-2023. Per the records of the eight Korean jobs, linked below, each completion date moved one to five months past the date set at award, and each job grew 27 to 401 percent in value.

Ship and job	Yard	Contract end: at award, latest	Value: award, latest
Wally Schirra, overhaul	Hanwha Ocean	Oct 2024, Mar 2025	$14.0M, $26.0M
Yukon, overhaul	Hanwha Ocean	Apr 2025, Jul 2025	$19.4M, $27.2M
Charles Drew, overhaul	Hanwha Ocean	Oct 2025, Feb 2026	$17.7M, $36.1M
Wally Schirra, mid-term	Hanwha Ocean	Dec 2025, Feb 2026	$5.6M, $7.1M
Alan Shepard, overhaul	HD Hyundai	Nov 2025, Dec 2025	$5.9M, $8.5M
Cesar Chavez, overhaul	HD Hyundai	Mar 2026, Apr 2026	$7.4M, $10.4M
Amelia Earhart, mid-term	HJ Shipbuilding & Construction	Mar 2026, Aug 2026	$3.9M, $19.4M
Richard E. Byrd, overhaul, no docking	HD Hyundai	Jun 2026, Oct 2026	$10.7M, $20.3M

Short jobs at Hanwha went the other way. The Federal Procurement Data System (FPDS) records for Hanwha's 2026 voyage repairs on Byrd at Chinhae and Miguel Keith show both closing on their award end dates and below their award values.

Earhart was booked short and grew within weeks. Its FPDS record shows a fixed-price award of about $3.9 million in December 2025, from five offers, due complete March 24. The first added money came on January 27, and about $11 million was obligated by March 24.

The public record trails the ship. Its USAspending record codes 22 of 24 modifications as supplemental agreements for work within scope, and its latest public entry, in July, puts completion at August 2. The ship was handed over on October 14, The Maritime Executive reported in an undated article read October 22.

The two accounts of who asked for the work describe different things: growth the yard found, and new work the owner added while it held the dock. HJ announced, The Herald Business reported in October, that it found defects outside the original scope and proposed remedies, which the Navy accepted. In June an HJ official told Asia Today, in United Press International's translation, that "the U.S. military continued to ask us to repair other items while the ship was already in the dock."

Wally Schirra's contract was shorter than its own plan. Its FPDS record shows an order signed August 28, 2024, on one offer, due complete October 18. Janes reported, undated, that the ship arrived on September 2 for "approximately three months." Military Sealift Command said in March 2025 that the ship "completed a seven-month regular overhaul."

Hanwha describes the approval loop. On Hanwha Ocean's recruiting site, undated, its project managers said that after each morning's progress meeting with the ship's master they review the Navy's added requests, analyze each for cost and schedule, and process a modified contract.

Some of Schirra's work had no drawing to plan from, and three sources describe it differently. Military Sealift Command said Hanwha reverse-engineered the rudder "when blueprint were not available," and gave no reason. A Hanwha project manager said on the recruiting site that the steering gear's drawings no longer existed because the ship was built long ago, so the team measured, drew new ones and won US approval. EBN reported in April 2025 that the US military withheld the ship's drawings for security reasons.

The newest contract names the growth. Byrd's USAspending record shows a July modification adjusting two line items for Military Sealift Command growth work on time and materials, with change

orders numbered past 150. The desk found no other record of the eight that names growth lines.

The bills keep arriving after the ship's date. Charles Drew's USAspending record shows modifications in April and June 2026, after its February contract end, settling 91 and then 87 change orders for about $9 million.

Read across the eight records, the award covers what was known before the ship was opened, and the rest arrives as change orders, settled in batches and sometimes after the ship's date. Expect Byrd's record to pass double its award once its later modifications post.

WHY IT MATTERS

Bottom line: When you plan any availability, and most of all a fixed-price one booked before the ship is opened, build the growth you expect into your controls: material ordered ahead for it and time held in the schedule. As the growth shows up or does not, give the unused time back to the ship's operator or use it to bring in another job.

Sources: USAspending award records for the eight jobs, read Oct 22, 2026; FPDS records, read Oct 22, 2026; The Herald Business, Oct 15, 2026; Asia Today via UPI, Jun 28, 2026; The Maritime Executive, undated, read Oct 22, 2026; Janes, undated; Military Sealift Command, Mar 13, 2025; Hanwha Ocean recruiting site, undated, read Oct 22, 2026; EBN, Apr 18, 2025

MAINTENANCE ENGINEERING & TECHNOLOGIES

What the shipyard found when it cut a new launcher into Zumwalt

The Navy added 230,000 hours of unplanned work to fitting a hypersonic missile into Zumwalt at Pascagoula. The Government Accountability Office (GAO) reported in July that this included more cabling than the project design planned, and program officials told GAO that a first restart of the class's key systems was another cause.

The whole class runs late. GAO's report of July 17 found the Navy "24 months behind" in modernizing all three Zumwalts for the Conventional Prompt Strike missile. On its June schedule, Zumwalt's Build Yard Modernization Period (BYMP) at Huntington Ingalls' Pascagoula yard would end in the fourth quarter of fiscal 2026, "a delay of 10 months" from a September 2025 plan, GAO said.

The desk found no record since GAO's report of whether Zumwalt finished by September 30, when that quarter ended.

The hours paid for unplanned work, and cable was part of it. GAO reported that program officials called unplanned work the "primary cause of recent delays" and that an August 2025 contract change added 230,000 hours for it at a cost of $20 million. That work covers, among other things, "more cabling than was anticipated in the initial project design," as the contractor cut out more than planned for the launch tubes. "The additional cabling was needed to match changes to the ship configuration since new construction cables were installed as part of the BYMP," GAO said.

The restart is a separate source. GAO said program officials named "the first time that the Navy has shut down and restarted key DDG 1000 class ship systems" as another source, citing electrical equipment failures. Officials also found efficiencies "early on" in assembling launch tube parts at the vendor's plant, before cost and schedule performance on Zumwalt degraded over the past year, GAO said.

Three companies split the job. A March 2024 contract notice carried by Defense Daily names Bath Iron Works the class planning yard. The Navy's FY2027 budget book says "The planning yard will address arrangements, primary structure, and existing distributive system impacts and reconstruction." It adds: "To support the BYMPs, the program established a sole-source contract with Huntington Ingalls Industries (HII) for production planning and execution." Lockheed Martin's undated feature says that its 2023 contract covers the launcher systems and weapon control. An August 18, 2022 contract notice carried by Defense Daily had Bath ordering long-lead material for Zumwalt's launch module. USNI News reported that the ship reached Ingalls in August 2023, a year later. The desk found no public record of a ship check or survey of the forward spaces before the design was fixed.

Michael Monsoor is next, and its package is already written. GAO said the same modernization period covers both in-service ships, and that Michael Monsoor is scheduled to begin it in February 2027. The work package NAVSEA (Naval Sea Systems Command) posted with its April 8 sources-sought notice estimates about 1,000,000 hours of modernization and 320,000 of repair, and lists "cabling pulling" among the key trades. For the restart it carries 500 man-days for light-off discrepancy correction, for "work not previously identified," and 25 man-days to correct deficiencies "which prevent safe light-off of the plant," the package says.

Those numbers suggest Monsoor's package names cable work as a trade from the start but carries the restart as a small allowance, a few hundred man-days against the 230,000 hours of unplanned work Zumwalt added. The class has restarted its plant once, and that restart's electrical failures delayed Zumwalt. So expect Monsoor's unplanned work to surface again at light-off, after the hull work is done,

and to arrive the way Zumwalt's did, as a contract change outside the planned hours.

WHY IT MATTERS

Bottom line: Before designing a new system into a ship that has been in service, ship-check every space it touches, because the drawings show the ship as built, not as it is now. Plan the first shutdown and restart of systems never restarted before as its own work, with its own hours. When one yard designs and another builds, the ship check belongs to both, before material is ordered.

Sources: GAO-26-107974, Jul 17, 2026; Department of the Navy, FY2027 Other Procurement, Navy budget justification, April 2026; Defense Daily, Mar 22, 2024; Defense Daily, Aug 18, 2022; Lockheed Martin, undated, read Oct 22, 2026; USNI News, Jan 21, 2026; NAVSEA, Enclosure (1) to sources-sought notice N00024-26-R-4443, Apr 8, 2026

BUSINESS PRACTICES & STRATEGY

Pascagoula's private propeller foundry adds machining capacity the company dates to early 2028

A $60 million expansion at the private propeller foundry in Pascagoula adds machining capacity that new-construction programs and submarines in service will share. The company says it comes online by the first quarter of 2028.

The Navy names both kinds of boat. The Navy said on October 21 that the new facility "will manufacture critical components for in-service and new-construction submarines" and will supply "critical components to several shipbuilding programs."

The name says what it adds. The release calls the $60 million project the "Bird-Johnson Propeller Company Machine Capacity Expansion."

Most of the Navy's share is Australia's. The Navy said it is contributing $27 million, $22 million of it from Australia, whose contribution "is focused on increasing maintenance and production capacity."

The added equipment is machine tools. Fairbanks Morse Defense said in an October 20 release Seapower carried that the center adds two five-axis CNC (computer numerical control) machines, for four in all, to "complement existing foundry capacity."

Casting gets only a future bay. Fairbanks Morse said the center "modernizes legacy foundry capabilities with a dedicated manufacturing bay for a future 3D sand printer." A sand printer makes casting molds, and the release gives no casting capacity figure.

The company calls it a doubling. Fairbanks Morse said the center will "effectively double capacity," that timelines for "the Virginia-class submarine program and next-generation surface combatants are accelerating," and that new capacity is "scheduled to come online by Q1 2028."

Hiring is the company's figure. Fairbanks Morse said the upgrade will grow the Pascagoula workforce by 25 percent, to a total of 100 craftspeople.

The company's "only" covers private plants. Fairbanks Morse said the plant is "the only privately-owned U.S. foundry certified for large-scale Navy propeller manufacturing," and that it bought Bird-Johnson in July 2025.

The Navy has its own foundry, which also repairs. Naval Sea Systems Command (NAVSEA) says of its Naval Foundry and Propeller Center in Philadelphia, as read 2026-10-22, that its "primary mission is to design, manufacture, and repair propellers for the US Navy."

Neither Pascagoula release says whether the plant repairs propellers.

What arrives by 2028 is machine time, while the mold printer is a future bay and no release sizes casting. Expect the gain after 2028 to show in machined parts first, with cast propulsor parts for submarines in service still held by mold and pour capacity.

WHY IT MATTERS

Bottom line: Nothing at Pascagoula changes before early 2028. After that, plan shorter lead times only for parts that wait on machining, and keep today's lead times for cast propulsor parts, because the new equipment is machine tools, not casting.

Sources: U.S. Navy via DVIDS, Oct 21, 2026; Fairbanks Morse Defense via Seapower, Oct 20, 2026; NAVSEA, Naval Foundry and Propeller Center, undated, read Oct 22, 2026

No leadership column this week; nothing in the pipeline had a study behind it.

The Waterfront Brief is compiled weekly by the B2 vault's research engine from primary sources and verified trade reporting. Scope: US shipbuilding, US Navy sustainment, and partners across the Indo-Pacific region; out-of-area items only when there is a direct, stated lesson. Freshness policy: every article's anchor source is under 12 months old; older material appears only as dated context or a flagged exception. A linked sentence means the named source says it, not that this desk has independently verified it. Corrections welcome; staged sources are retained for audit.

UPCOMING EVENTS

Nearest first, filling the page. **Bold** marks a decision that closes inside the next 60 days. NSRP is the National Shipbuilding Research Program, the industry-Navy body that funds shared shipyard process research; SNAME is the Society of Naval Architects and Marine Engineers; NSL is the Naval Submarine League; SAE is SAE International, which runs the Department of War Maintenance Symposium; SNA is the Surface Navy Association; DSI is the Defense Strategies Institute; NDIA is the National Defense Industrial Association; AFCEA is the Armed Forces Communications and Electronics Association and USNI the U.S. Naval Institute; AMPP is the Association for Materials Protection and Performance; ASNE is the American Society of Naval Engineers; the AMDA Foundation is the Australian body that runs the Indo Pacific exposition.

Dates	Event	Register by	Why it matters
Oct 28-30, 2026	SNAME Maritime Convention 2026, Royal Sonesta Houston Galleria, Houston, TX (SNAME)	Not printed	Workforce pipeline: naval architects, marine engineers and yard production people in one technical program
Nov 12-13, 2026	Naval Submarine League Annual Symposium 2026, Arlington, VA (NSL)	To be posted	Submarine industrial base: the submarine force and its yards set the year's priorities
Dec 8-11, 2026	Department of War Maintenance Symposium 2026, Fort Lauderdale, FL (SAE for DoW)	**Open; rates rise after Nov 7**	Maintenance execution: the department-wide depot maintenance meeting
Jan 12-14, 2027	SNA National Symposium 2027, Arlington, VA (SNA)	Not yet open	Program priorities: where the surface force states its maintenance priorities
Jan 26-28, 2027	Military Additive Manufacturing Summit (MILAM), Tampa, FL (DSI)	Early rate closed Oct 2	Additive qualification: defense additive qualification and NAVSEA-spec adoption
Feb 8-10, 2027	NDIA Annual Logistics Forum 2027, Renaissance Orlando at SeaWorld, Orlando, FL (NDIA)	Not printed	Supply chain: lifecycle sustainment and supply-chain community (the 41st forum)
Feb 16-18, 2027	WEST 2027, San Diego, CA (AFCEA/USNI)	Not printed	Program priorities: the Pacific-side sea services conference
Mar 23-25, 2027	NSRP All Panel Meeting 2027, North Charleston, SC (NSRP)	"Coming soon"	Regional capacity: where yard R&D ideas get teamed program-wide
Apr 4-7, 2027	Sea-Air-Space 2027, National Harbor, MD (Navy League)	Not yet open	Program priorities: the largest US maritime defense exposition
Apr 11-15, 2027	AMPP Annual Conference + Expo 2027, Columbus, Ohio (AMPP)	Abstracts closed Oct 1; attendee registration not printed	Preservation: the corrosion and coatings profession's main event
Jun 8-10, 2027	MegaRust 2027, Hampton, VA (ASNE)	Attendee registration not yet open	Maintenance execution: the Navy corrosion event
Nov 2-4, 2027	Indo Pacific 2027 International Maritime Exposition, Sydney (AMDA Foundation)	Not published yet	Supply chain / policy engagement: the Pacific's naval industry exposition; allied yards exhibit